United Nations
Educational, Scientific and
Cultural Organization

Intangible
Cultural
Heritage

Welcome to the Ori of Blika

Unit 46 Ori PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

Barranquilla Carnival (c) 2011 Matt Wootton

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The Ori, a new minority in Blika

- 1960/1970s - 80.000 Ori arrive in Blika
- Ori - 1 out of 5 officially recognized new minorities
- Approximately 200,000 Ori in Blika (no statistics)
- 4 old minorities – together approximately 100,000 people
- 80% Blika majority speak Blikanese
- Many young people identify themselves as Ori and Blika without feeling half Ori

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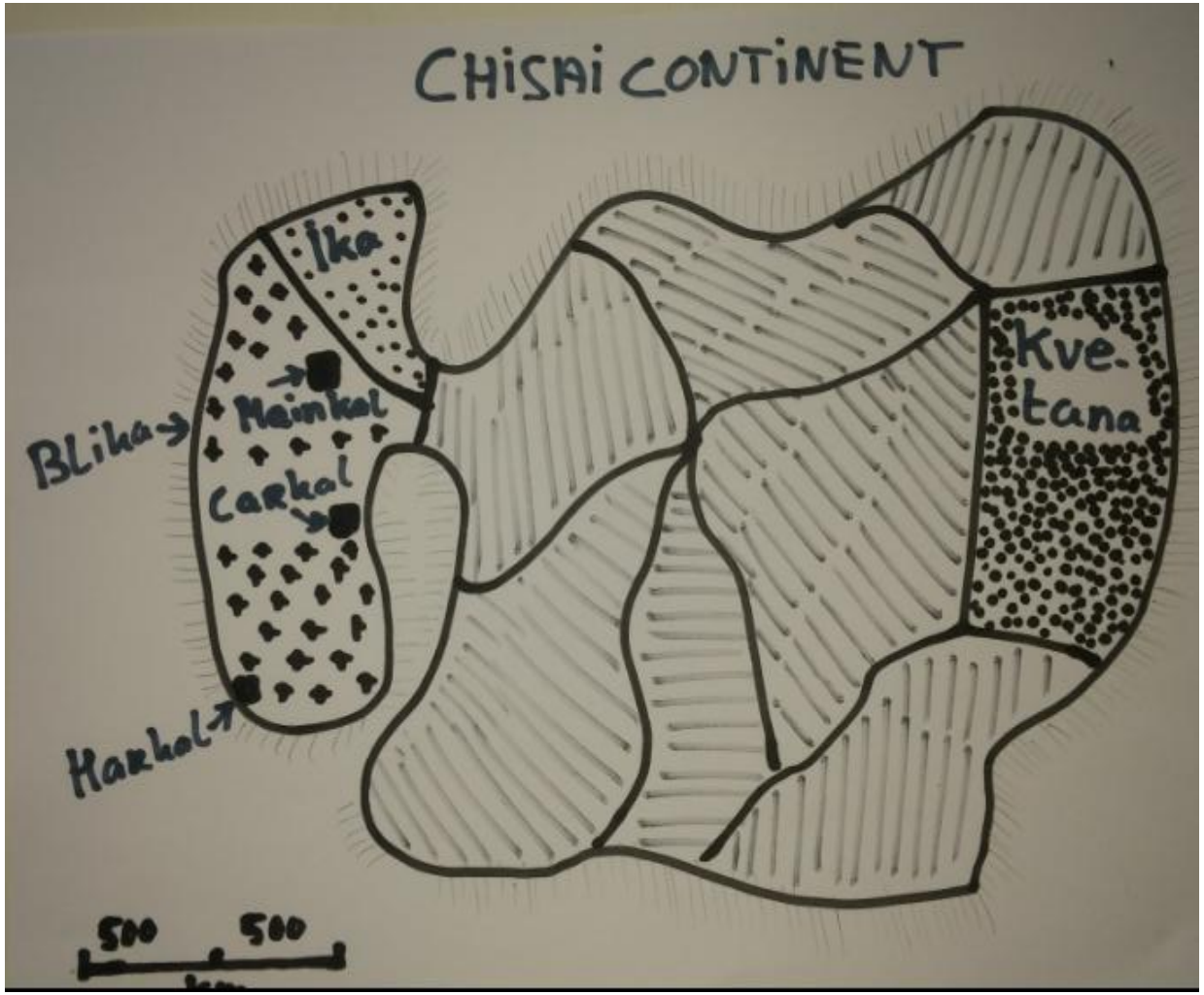
Map of the Chisai continent



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Integration, assimilation, intolerance, indifference

- Ori men work in factories; women in nurseries
- Integration centres and assimilation classes in schools ensured quick integration
- 1980/2000: economy in depression - assimilationist policies and majority population rather hostile towards immigrants
- Today attitude turning into indifference
- Few contacts among minorities

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In between

- Immigrants can receive Blika citizenship after ten years – have to adopt the Blika naming system practice
- Ori unhappy they cannot use their own name giving system, their ‘real’ names
- Ori created coffee houses (mainly for men) and tea gardens for traditional weddings
- Ori continue speaking Ori among them, having their tattoos, and prefer marrying among them.
- Ori remember well the ‘years of intolerance’, which for many are not really over.

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Since 2000: Policies, public opinion, profile

- Beginning of economic revival
- Policies becoming more tolerant, though not the regulations
- Blika public opinion still between indifferent and intolerant
- Ori live mainly in 3 major towns
- Ori are well integrated
- Ori keep low profile in public space
- They maintain contacts with Ika and Kvetana

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Blika policies towards immigrants

1960s-1970s: Ori immigration into Blika from Kvetana

1970s: Social integration centres created in Blika

1960-2005: Government in Blika generally adopts assimilationist public policies

1985-2000: less tolerance by government and Blika majority towards minorities

2005: Government policies more favourable to minorities in Blika

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Ori organize themselves

- About 12 cultural clubs/associations/NGOs
- Many archery clubs for men and women
- Many top ball clubs, but only 2 adapted fields
- 10 to 15 % non-Ori members in archery and top ball clubs
- Bilingual Ori Cultural Portal, informs about Blika events and culture; other Ori websites and blogs
- Ori Language Support organizes Ori courses in all major towns – attended by young Ori (literacy courses) and non-Ori partners of Ori

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Ori in Blika, Ika and Kvetana

- Contacts among Ori in Blika and Ika
- Change of regime in Kvetana but hardly any Ori returned, some visit relatives in Kvetana
- Kvetana ratified the Convention in 2005: only 11 Ori elements out of 200 on the country inventory (Ori 20% of total population)
- From vibrant to declining: Top ball; rope-walking; wedding dance/music; Ori language; improvised poetry; tattooing; archery; story-telling; cock fighting; lace making; falconry; traditional healing

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Blika ratifies in 2013

- Ministry and UNESCO: several capacity-building workshops
- Authorities identify 10 communities to start implementation at the national level
- Five landed immigrant groups (incl. Ori), 4 old minorities; 80% Blika majority
- Ministry created **Blika ICH Council**: 24 members, all experts; 12 from the minorities
- Ori SafeCom: safeguarding committee
- Blika ICH Council manages preliminary inventory of ICH in Blika

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Blika implements the Convention

2013: Blika ratifies the Convention

2014: Training workshops about the Convention and its implementation

Late 2014: Blika ICH Council created to oversee and guide the implementation of the Convention

Community Safeguarding Committees (SafeComs) created to identify important ICH and plan safeguarding initiatives

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Soon a 2-day meeting of Ori SafeCom

- SafeComs were asked to:
  a) draft lists of ICH
  b) prepare safeguarding plan for endangered ICH
  c) propose 2 to 4 ICH elements of Ori ICH for the preliminary inventory
- Ori SafeCom drew up list of 11 elements of Ori ICH
- Organizes two-day meeting: 6 Ori SafeCom members with 6 other (Ori) experts deal with points (b) and – time allowing – (c)

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Meet your neighbours 1

- President Ori Women's Association
- History and geography teacher
- Tea garden owner
- Electric equipment shop owner
- Head baker
- Bookseller and writer
- Webmaster Ori Culture Portal

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Meet your neighbours 2

- Sociologist
- General Practitioner
- Journalist
- Heritage official Ministry of Culture
- Member of Blika NATCOM for UNESCO
- External consultant

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President of Ori Women's Association

- Born around 1975
- Human rights lawyer
- Published two books on Ori foodways
- Wants Ori name-giving tradition recognized
- Believes Ori wedding celebrations are important for Ori identity

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History and geography teacher

- Young Ori
- Recorded songs, memories and life stories of first generation Ori in Blika
- Recorded Ori fairy tales, but these are not allowed to be public
- Social member of Archery association
- Parents traumatized by the treatment of minorities in Blika

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Harkal Tea garden Owner

- 50 years old, owns Harkal tea garden
- Organizes Ori weddings
- Good traditional and non-traditional singer
- Central figure in haf (mutual assistance) arrangements
- Wants more public broadcasts of Ori music and dance
- Wants more public respect for Ori ICH

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Electric equipment shop owner

- 40 years old, Ori, citizen of Carkal
- Good storyteller and writer in Ori language
- Shop sells electrical equipment and Ori bows and arrows
- Shop was attacked in 2004 after publication of bilingual Ori/Blika announcements
- Wants to promote language-related human rights in Blika through the Convention

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Head baker

- 24 years old, lives in Harkal
- Ori father and Blika mother
- Head of a bakery department in a supermarket
- Sells own Ori-Ori-Rap on internet
- Active member of the Ori Youth Association
- Performs as a DJ

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Bookseller and writer

- Arrived in Blika aged 7
- Owns a bookshop in Mainkal and writes Ori novels
- Frequent visitor to Ori coffee houses and tea gardens
- Wants to revitalize the Ori chain dance and train more singers and musicians

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Webmaster Ori Culture Portal

- 22 years old
- Both Ori and Blika heritage
- Learned Ori lacemaking and archery
- BA in General History of the Chisai Continent at Harkal University
- Coordinates bilingual Ori Culture Portal
- Encouraging ‘old minority’ students to set up their own portals

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Sociologist

- 28 years old, of Kvetana origin
- As child assimilated into Ori group in Blika
- Studied the role of culture in the history of immigration in Blika
- Plays traditional Ori musical instruments
- Wants non-formal education to promote transmission of Ori dancing, singing, poetry and lace making

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General Practitioner

- Born in 1975 in Carkal and works in a small town
- Founding member of the Ori Students Association
- Documents Ori traditional medicine practices
- Publishes on Ori Culture Portal
- Wants better treatment and equal rights for minorities

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Journalist

- Age 40, lives in Mainkal with Blika partner; families speaks Blika and Ori
- Editor of the cultural pages in Mainkal Herald, covering Blika culture
- Interviews Ori performers for the bilingual Ori Blika Monthly
- Publishes Ori oral poetry
- Wants better appreciation of ICH, improved training facilities and remuneration for traditional artists

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Heritage official Ministry of Culture

- Ori aged 38 years
- Lives with Mora (Traveller minority) partner in Mainkal
- Ori archer and lead dancer; plays Mora indoor games
- MA in heritage studies at Harkal University on heritage of Old Minorities
- Would like the various minorities in Blika to be more interested in each other's ICH
- Believes Ori wedding parties are important for Ori identity and transmission of ICH

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Member of Blika NATCOM for UNESCO

- Blika, 40 years old, lives in Harkal
- Ori partner died at 35
- Speaks some Ori, collects Ori proverbs and practises Ori archery
- Lobbied in Blika for the adoption of the 2003 and 2005 Conventions
- Would like museums to pay attention to minorities
- Wants better relations between all Blika citizens

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External consultant

- Blika national
- Facilitated some of the capacity-building workshops in Blika
- Has many Ori friends
- In front of you

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Ori ICH in Blika

- Traditional Ori wedding
- Top ball game
- Haf – mutual assistance
- Ori name-giving
- Ori new year and cooking
- Ori fortune-telling and traditional healing
- Ori midwifery
- Ori improvised poetry
- Ori traditional dancing
- Ori traditional music and singing
- Ori archery

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Traditional Ori wedding

- The ‘backbone’ of Ori ICH in Blika
- Weekend events in Ori tea gardens or restaurants
- Many guests, long tables
- Singing, speeches, games, dances (circle dances; rarely chain dancing), gifts, jokes
- Not enough large venues
- Non-Ori venues do not like the noise and uncountable cars parking
- Not enough musicians and singers
- Too expensive for many young Ori

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Top ball game

- Played on a field laid out in a circle
- Teams of 9 men or women
- Over 20 top ball clubs but only two special fields in Blika
- Competitions since the 1990s; students organize Blika-Ika championship
- Ori fruit drinks and fatty snacks served at games
- 10% non-Ori members

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Ori name giving

- Ori infants given names during a ceremony three months after birth
- Ori first names linked to seasons or circumstances
- Surname of all children in an Ori family follows the gender of the parent of the first born
- On obtaining Blika citizenship, one has to adapt surname; first name for newborn to be to selected from a list Blika names
- Blika citizens must take their father's surname

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Ori new year and cooking

- Ori dishes: roast mutton, sugar duck, dumplings, sour cabbage salad and pies, pancakes and cookies
- New year celebrations:
  - 8pm: Ori new year (midnight in Kvetana)
  - Traditional dancing, singing
  - Renewal of haf relations
  - 12pm: Blika new year with lots of fireworks and dancing

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Haf – mutual assistance

- Mutual assistance between friends and relatives (services, loans, adoption, repairs)
- Agreements usually concluded in the presence of a haf witness
- Not all haf agreements are legal under Blika law

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Ori fortune-telling and traditional healing

- Practiced by women
- Fortune tellers read tea leaves and palms
- Healers use laying on of hands and singing
- For problems like headache, backache, allergies, sleeplessness and grief after separation
- Blika tax authorities are interested in undeclared income
- In Kvetana traditional healing is forbidden by law as being non-scientific

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Ori improvised poetry

- Common in Kvetana and Blika
- No restrictions
- In Blika only 7-8 male and female semi-professional poets – not enough for weddings and other functions
- Practiced by amateurs – for fun
- Contests and festivals
- Thought to be endangered

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Ori midwifery

- Two thirds of Ori mothers give birth at home
- Assisted by trained Ori midwives
- Post-birth ceremonies at home
- No increased health risks for Ori home births; fewer mental health problems among Ori mothers after birth
- Public health authorities in Blika want to reduce home births

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Ori traditional dancing (in Blika)

- Circle and chain dance
- Danced at weddings and other social events
- Diversity of the Ori circle dance diminishing
- Chain dance is rarely danced anymore
- Official permission is still required – and not easily given – for dancing in public spaces

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Ori traditional music and singing

- Ori accordion, the Utur flute and the Ori wooden clappers used in Blika
- Instruments bought in Kvetana
- Traditional lullabies, choral wedding songs and polyphonic naming ceremony songs
- Decline in improvisation
- Not enough (semi-) professional musicians and singers available for hire or training

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Ori Archery

- Common pastime for men in Kvetana
- Blika has no indigenous archery tradition
- Ori archery clubs also accept non-Ori
- Practiced in wooden structures attached to Ori coffee houses, not outdoors
- Women train with men
- Some structures dilapidated; may get closed by municipality

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